

Economics

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How Maschina earns, where value moves, and the incentive we refuse to acquire

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Abstract

Maschina earns from work performed, never from outcomes promised. This document sets out the revenue model, where value moves between owners, creators and operators, the position on credits and tokens, the numbers that decide whether a business works, and what would break it.

1. The principle, and why it is the first section

Maschina earns from work performed. It does not earn from outcomes, and it never claims them.

This is a structural decision rather than a modest one. The evidence on active trading is consistent across decades and jurisdictions: ninety seven percent of persistent day traders in the largest study of the question lost money net of fees, with fewer than one in a hundred earning more than a bank teller

[3]. The most active traders in a long study of brokerage accounts underperformed the market by more than six points annually, and under one percent of day traders in a fifteen year study were reliably profitable [4].

A business that only earns when its users profit will eventually need its users to believe they are profiting. That single pressure produces most of the dishonesty this industry is known for. Charging for work removes the pressure entirely, and it is why every result in this product is displayed beside the benchmark of having done nothing at all.

2. Revenue

Source	Basis
Execution fees	A percentage of each action, faster paths priced above scheduled ones
Copy revenue	A share of the fee on copied machines, the remainder to the creator
Subscription	Higher limits, more machines, priority execution, earlier access
Network share	A portion of what the network earns selling compute, bandwidth and execution
Issuance fees	A fee on assets issued through the platform
Machine payments	A fee on payments machines make to services and to each other
Idle yield share	A portion of yield earned on balances that would otherwise sit idle

Rates are published on the pricing page rather than here, so they are never authoritative in two places at once.

3. Where value goes

Owners keep what their machines earn, net of fees, and funds return only to them. Creators earn for as long as copies of their machines run. Node operators earn for verified work at rates set by scheduling. Reporters earn bounties for defects and for assets the checks missed. Maschina takes a share of activity.

4. Credits, and the question of a token

There is no token.

An internal credit unit is the appropriate instrument first: earned by operators for capacity, spent by owners on execution and priority, denominated in work that actually occurred.

If a token is ever issued, three commitments made in advance govern it. It follows real usage rather than preceding it. It buys things, being compute, priority, fee discounts and bonds, rather than representing a share of profits. And it is not a fundraising mechanism presented as a product.

Maschina will not operate its own chain. Solana provides throughput, cost, speed and the breadth of assets reachable from it, and a chain of our own would add a decade of work to solve a problem we do not have [5].

5. The numbers that decide this

Fee per active machine per month, which follows from how often a machine acts rather than how much it holds. **Machines per owner**, which is the difference between a tool and a platform. **Copy revenue per published machine**, which is where the marketplace becomes a business rather than a feature. **Cost per machine hour**, which falls sharply once execution moves onto contributed hardware.

The first commercial milestone is deliberately unglamorous: the founder's own machines covering the platform's running costs. It requires no other participant, it is measurable within weeks, and a system that cannot clear it has no business asking anyone else for money.

6. The moat

Not strategies, which anyone can copy. Not models, which are commodities. Not compute, which is purchased.

The moat is being the place where software can be trusted with money, and it has three components: the custody design, the record that makes that behavior possible, and the standing that accumulates on top of it. All three strengthen with use. None can be forked, because a record with no history is worth nothing, and history is the one asset that cannot be copied.

7. What would break this

Fee compression. Competitors arrive and execution fees fall toward zero. Our fee is for safety and execution quality rather than routing, and both are measured and published, which is defensible but not indefinitely.

Regulation. Parts of the surface become unavailable in significant markets. Trading a person's own funds on their own instruction is by far the lightest case, which is one reason it is first. The rest arrive with a structure or not at all.

Custody concentration. Being the safest place to hold machine funds makes Maschina the most valuable target in the category. Security spending scales with success permanently, and is treated as a cost of goods rather than overhead.

Machines not performing. If funded machines do not beat doing nothing, owners stop funding them. There is no mitigation except measuring honestly, publishing the benchmark beside every result, and letting people decide with real information. Every other response to this risk is a lie with a delay on it.

8. References

- [3] F. Chague, R. De-Losso and B. Giovannetti. *Day Trading for a Living?* SSRN 3423101.
- [4] B. Barber and T. Odean. *Trading is Hazardous to Your Wealth*, and subsequent work on the Taiwan Stock Exchange.
- [5] A. Yakovenko. *Solana: A new architecture for a high performance blockchain*, 2017.